

allows its user to manage all aspects of a biz, namely Sales force management, Customer relations, Marketing, Inventory control etc. An online demo is available on the home page. The interface is loaded with menus and submenus which allow recording and tracking progress on different areas of the biz. But, to make any sensible use of these features some form of orientation would be required. While there is a user manual on the site, getting to it requires some dedicated clicking. vtiger also offers plugins to integrate with popular applications such as Thunderbird (email client) and MS office so that documents from these applications can be integrated with the CRM. vtiger offers an excellent mix of features and the price, as well, make it an essential application for every SMB.

Sugar CRM (www.sugarcrm.com) is another open source CRM application that is highly rated among users. The community edition of the application is free.

2.8.4 Additional Resources

For a list of open source solutions for SMBs, head to www.Linuxplanet.com/Linuxplanet/reviews/6796/1/

Conclusion

The open source movement caters to every need of a professional. The beauty of the open source scheme lies in the ability of any user to modify an existing application to better suit his/her needs, thereby creating a new application that will find takers. This and the price of the application are strong reasons to give open source applications a try.